

Michael Van Horn

Twin Cities, MN · contact@michaelvanhorn.me · [linkedin.com/in/michaelvanhorn06](https://www.linkedin.com/in/michaelvanhorn06) · michaelvanhorn.me

Human Resource Development candidate working on the human side of AI in the workplace. I redesign how teams work around AI tools and train people until they own them, pairing an HRD foundation in training design and change management with hands-on experience building and deploying AI tools, alongside co-authored research on AI adoption and job stress.

EXPERIENCE

Meet Minneapolis — Equity & Community Impact Intern Mar 2026 – Present · Minneapolis, MN

- Secured IT approval for Copilot and opened an org-wide Claude trial at a 200-person organization, advancing enterprise AI adoption from an intern seat.
- Built a Heritage Month flyer pipeline in Python that replaced a recurring manual process; it now runs monthly, owned end to end by the team.
- Designed a supplier-directory audit tool: automated liveness verification, reputation scans, and a structured flag-for-review workflow.
- Support equity and community impact initiatives reporting to the VP of ECI, deliver professional development programming, and maintain the Diverse Suppliers, CSR, and Multicultural Media directories.

Waaban — Co-founder & CEO Mar 2026 – Present

- Co-founded and lead an AI-powered market-analysis platform on a 3-person founding team, owning strategic direction, operations, and brand (40% equity); the product runs on a 9-state Hidden Markov Model for market-regime detection.

University of Minnesota, Career Services — Operations & Enablement Assistant Jun 2025 – Mar 2026 · Minneapolis, MN

- Authored the office's first formal AI usage policy — a FERPA-compliant SOP defining approved and prohibited uses, data-protection requirements, and quality standards for AI tools — adopted across all staff and student employees and approved by the Executive Director.
- Designed a three-module prompting-training curriculum (AI fundamentals, prompting techniques, hands-on practice) plus an office-wide quick-reference, equipping non-technical staff to use AI responsibly.
- Authored the SOPs the team runs on — front-desk operations, shared-inbox triage, and Handshake employer-posting review — standardizing the work and reducing onboarding time.

Red Lake School District — HR & Logistics Intern Jan 2024 – Aug 2024 · Red Lake, MN

- Executed full-cycle recruiting: drafted postings, screened candidates, ran new-hire orientation, verified I-9s and background checks, and maintained HRIS records.
- Managed 300+ weekly package deliveries across three locations with a 100% on-time record, integrating Ojibwe cultural values consistent with Red Lake Nation standards.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Marked in Red (Next.js, Supabase, Leaflet) — an interactive awareness map for Missing and Murdered Indigenous Women, Girls, and Two-Spirit people, built and deployed as a live demo on sample data.

Townfolk (Python, Claude API) — a multi-agent governance system enforcing data integrity across a personal knowledge base; designed the agent roles and event-driven hook enforcement.

m365-bridge (MCP server) — gave an AI coding agent live read/write access to Outlook, Teams, and Calendar; in daily production use at work.

RESEARCH

- Co-authored a manuscript on AI adoption and job stress using RAND American Life Panel data (n=793) and multiple linear regression; synthesized 76 practitioner articles into four evidence-based training-and-development recommendations. Presented at the 2026 OLPD Student Research Conference (UMN).

EDUCATION

University of Minnesota–Twin Cities — B.S., Human Resource Development (CEHD / OLPD) Expected Dec 2026

- GPA 3.71 · UMN Honor Society · Foundation for Rural Service Scholarship.

Bemidji State University — Associate of Arts (AA), Liberal Arts & Sciences 2022 – 2024

- GPA 3.84 · PSEO.

Certifications — AI Fluency: Framework & Foundations (Anthropic, 2026) · Claude 101 (Anthropic, 2026)

SKILLS

Building with AI: Python, JavaScript / TypeScript, Next.js, Supabase, Claude API (agents, MCP servers, multi-agent orchestration), Git / GitHub.

HR & people ops: full-cycle recruiting, onboarding and I-9, HRIS, SOP development, training design, change management, stakeholder communications, equity strategy.

Tools: PeopleSoft, Handshake, Qualtrics, Microsoft 365 / Copilot, Trello.

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY

SHRM Club (UMN) · Foundation for Rural Service, represented Northern Minnesota at the National Policy & Telecom Summit, Washington, DC · Oshkiimaajitahdah cultural program volunteer.